



Original Ship = Continuous Ship

This is not a story of a ship crashing into itself; it seems fairly clear that



Original Ship = Reconstructed Ship



Continuous Ship $\neq$ Reconstructed Ship

The problem, though, is that these three claims are inconsistent. This is due to the transitivity of identity: if $A=B$, and $B=C$, then $A=C$.

What's the best way out of this paradox?

One natural thought is that we should reject the claim that Original Ship is the same as Reconstructed Ship. On this view, if you find all of the parts that composed some thing, and put them back together, that is not enough to reconstitute the thing. Rather, on this view, material objects survive via a series of causal connections over time, perhaps with the requirement that only relatively small changes at one time are possible.

We might state this view of the conditions under which material objects continue to exist as follows:

Let's turn to our second question for materialist theories.

Which material object must survive for me to survive?

**For me to survive,
which material thing
has to continue to
exist?**

As we saw above, it is very natural for the materialist to say that I am an organism. So, it would be natural for the materialist to say that my survival requires the survival of the human organism which I am. Let's call this **the organism view**.



Originalship = Derivativship



Original Ship = Registered Ship



Contracting Ship $\neq$ Registered Ship

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Today we turn to our third big question. This question can be introduced by an

example.

Suppose that in the year 2069 the surviving members of this Introduction to

Philosophy class decided to have an Intro to Philosophy reunion, and all gathered in

this room. Suppose that they decided to get a group picture taken.

show it to you. You might ask: Am I one of those people? Which one am I?

Now imagine that, via some sort of time travel device, I have that photo, and

There must be some fact of the matter about whether or not the people in the photo

But is every natural assumption that these questions must have determined answers?

you.

is you. And, if one is you, there must be some fact about which one is

in this picture, and must be a fact about which the survivors agree.

Let's suppose that this is true: there must be a fact about whether you survive to be

Then we can ask a question about these facts:



To introduce our main answers to the survival question, it will be

useful to think about simple, universal example of survival.

sitting in your seat is the same person as — identical to — the person

the same point another way, all of you believe that the person now

All of you believe that you will wake up tomorrow in your bed. To put

who will wake up in bed tomorrow.

What do we mean when we say that you are identical to that person?

attended to, can make these questions more confusing than they have to be.

Here it is important to get clear at the outset on one distinction which, if not

This is the distinction between numerical and qualitative identity.

Today that x and y are numerically identical is to say that they are literally the

same thing — they are one, not two.

To say that x and y things are qualitatively identical is to say that they

exactly resembling — they have just the same properties.

When we say that you are identical to the person who will get out of your bed

identical to that person. Their hair will be messed up, and they will be wearing

to morning, we are not of course saying that you are qualitatively

different clothes.

Rather, we mean that you are numerically identical to that person: there is just

one person who is today in this class, and is tomorrow in that bed.

the same person as the person who will wake up in that bed?

But then we can ask the survival question: in virtue of what are you numerical

widely held view that we are not simply material beings, but

But this is not the only answer to our question. It is a

also have innovative materials.

If one believes in immaterial souls, then it is natural to think

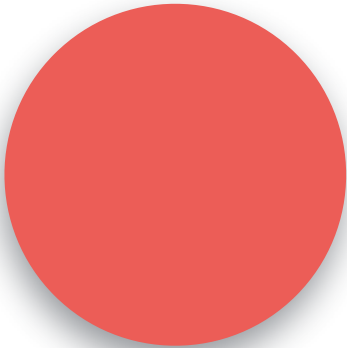
existence in material soul.

that one's survival is closely linked to the continued

because they are, or have, the same immaterial soul.

the person who wakes up in that bed tomorrow is you

This suggests an alternative theory of survival. On this view,



But these are not the only possible views here. One might

also hold that you are that person not because of any

immaterial souls, but rather because psychological

connections between you and that person.

physical connections, and not be afraid of anything involving

focus on memories. On this view, the thing which makes

Which psychological connections? One popular approach

you the same person as the person who will wake up in that

bedtime is your shared memories.

Of course there are plenty of other psychological

connections you will have to that person as well. You will

have very similar beliefs and desires, and very similar

personalities.

Let's call the idea that you are the same person because of

you're psychologically disconnected psychologically survival.

It is worth pausing to think about the difference between the soul

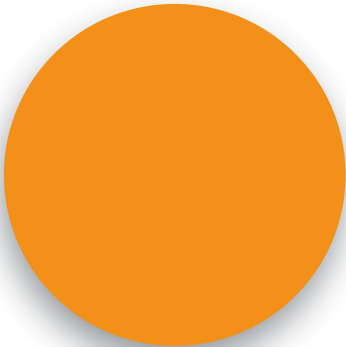
theory and the psychological theory of survival. At a first glance,

they can look like the same thing. But they are not.

In ordinary language, 'soul' is sometimes used as a synonym for

'mind.' But remember that in the present context a soul is an

material thing which is closely connected to your identity.



You will be glad to know that we are not going to go

through these seven theories on the by-one. Instead, we

will look at a series of arguments and thought

of these theories.

experiments which seem to make trouble for a number

existence of immaterial souls. If successful, such an

argument would rule out 4 of our 7 theories.

For example, we will look at arguments against the

seen to count against the idea that survival requires

First, though, I want to look at some arguments which

same of material thing. That would rule out 4

of our 7 theories.

We know that materialist theories require the survival

of some material thing. But which one?

As we saw above, it is very natural for the materialist

for the materialist to say that my survival requires the

to say that I am a nongorganism. So, it would be natural

survival of the human organism which I am. Let's call

this the organization view.

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